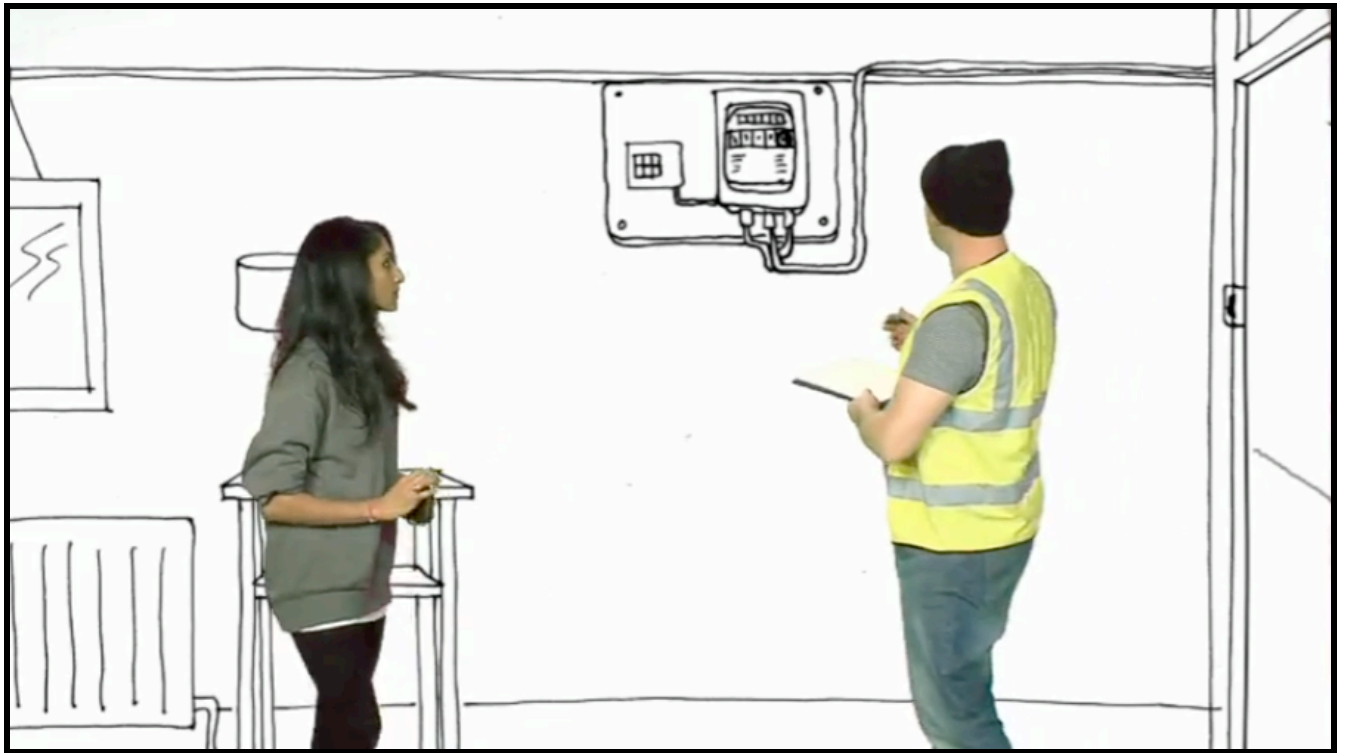


English in my home – Someone at the door

Unit 1a – Electricity meter reading



Contents

Unit 1a

Electricity meter reading – teacher's notes

Electricity meter reading – learner resources

Electricity meter reading – video transcript

Electricity meter reading – answers

Video

Introduction

This resource has been produced in two different formats:

- a self-access resource for learners with online activities
- this teacher's pack, including teacher's notes and worksheets to download

Overview

This resource, ***Someone at the door – Electricity meter reading***, is part of Unit 1 of *English in my home*, which aims to give ESOL learners the confidence and the language to deal with situations they may encounter in their homes.

There are three units of ***English in my home***:

Unit 1 Someone at the door aims to give learners confidence and equip them with the language necessary to deal with situations where unexpected callers (e.g. an electricity meter reader) arrive at the door.

Unit 2 Someone on the phone shows how to deal with incoming phone calls from a range of people. This includes unwanted calls (e.g. marketing cold calls).

Unit 3 Something in the post features some common types of mail that people receive (e.g. a utility bill), and enables learners to understand what the text means, and to know what to do in response.

Level: Entry 2 / Access 3 in Scotland / CEF A2. The materials are designed to be flexible in terms of differentiation, and are accessible to established E2 learners and at the same time relevant to E1, as well as E3 and L1.

Structure, learning hours and delivery context

English in my home provides a minimum of 11 hours of learning in a classroom or self-access context through a series of three linked units. Each unit can be taught as a standalone. Here is an overview of the content of each unit. Each unit has four topics:

Unit 1: Someone at the door (includes films)

- **Topic a: Electricity meter reading (the focus of this set of resources)**
- Topic b: Charity collection
- Topic c: Parcel delivery
- Topic d: The neighbour

Unit 2: Someone on the phone (includes films)

- Topic a: Cold call
- Topic b: Wrong number
- Topic c: An emergency
- Topic d: Getting a plumber

Unit 3: Something in the post

- Topic a: Bank statement
- Topic b: Phone bill
- Topic c: Attempted delivery note
- Topic d: Note from a neighbour

Each of the four topics in *Someone at the door* and *Someone on the phone* features a short film. These films have been scripted specifically for the project, and involve actors. The two central characters are a married Indian couple, who have recently moved to the UK, and who are getting used to life here. Each film focuses on them in a specific scenario, such as dealing with a meter reader who arrives at their flat, or dealing with unwanted cold calls on the telephone. ESOL learners should be able to relate to the experiences of the couple.

The learner materials and teacher notes contain activities for use before, during and after watching the films. They enable the learners to notice, learn and use some of the functional language featured in the films.

Something in the post, uses semi-authentic material of the kinds that learners may receive in their home, and helps them to understand these and know what action is needed.

Most topics provide approximately 60 minutes of classroom time. Units 1 and 2 can last longer if teachers choose to use the transcripts, for example by getting the learners to act out sections of the dialogues.

Unit 1 Someone at the door: overview

The unit provides up to 4 hours of classroom time, and covers 4 topics. Each topic features a short film, commissioned by the British Council for the ESOL Nexus project, and filmed with professional actors. The films aim to show real-life situations in which ESOL learners may find themselves, and the accompanying classroom and self-study materials aim to give learners the language they need to deal with a range of household situations.

The 4 topics of *Someone at the door* are called *Electricity meter reading*, *Charity collection*, *Parcel delivery* and *The Neighbour* and can be used in any order.

Electricity meter reading – teacher's notes

Time:

Approximately 60 minutes. Timings are flexible.

Aims

- To enable learners to speak with a meter reader who comes to their own home

Objectives

Learners will be able to:

- understand the gist and detail of the film
- use some useful phrases for dealing with visitors to their home
- use the infinitive with 'to' after certain verbs

Preparation

You will need:

- Learner resources (pages 10 -12)
- Transcript (page 13-14) – one per learner if you wish to use this
- an internet connection and data projector to play the film

Suggested Procedure

Lead-in

Introduce the topic of household bills. Put the learners in pairs, and give them a couple of minutes to discuss the following questions. You could dictate the questions before you write them on the board.

- *What bills do you have to pay each month?*
- *How do you pay the bills?*
- *How do you know if the bill is correct?*

Conduct brief whole-class feedback, trying to ensure that quieter learners are also given a chance to give their answers. If anyone says that they received a bill in error, or one that was too high, tell them that this class will help them know how to avoid this sort of problem in future. While conducting feedback, pre-teach phrases connected to utility bills, e.g. *pay the electricity/gas bill, read the meter, pay by cheque, by direct debit* etc. Write up the verb/noun combinations on the board and check pronunciation.

First viewing: gist listening task

Explain that you are going to show the learners a film that deals with household bills. In the film, we meet Sunita, a young Indian woman who lives in a flat in London. (We also briefly meet her husband, Arjun, at the end of the film.) Ask the learners to watch the film, and answer these two questions:

1. *Why did the man come to Sunita's flat?*
2. *What is Sunita going to get in the post?*

Put the learners in pairs to discuss the gist questions for a couple of minutes. Then conduct whole-class feedback.

1. He came to read her electricity meter; this is a machine which shows how much electricity she has used.
2. She is going to receive her electricity bill soon.

When conducting feedback, ask the learners briefly if a meter reader has ever called at their home. Ask if they understood what he/she wanted. Explain to the learners why it's very important to take meter readings (electricity, gas and water) when you move into a new home, or when you move out, as this ensures their bills are accurate. Also, encourage learners to use any phrases connected with bills which you may have pre-taught in the previous stage, e.g. *pay the electricity/gas bill, read the meter, pay by cheque, by direct debit etc.*

Task 1: understanding the film

Put the learners in pairs, and ask them to look at the questions in Task 1 together for a couple of minutes. If necessary, read the questions to the learners and check understanding. Having seen the film once, the learners may be able to answer some of the questions already from memory. Play the film again if you feel your learners would benefit. Give the learners a few moments to compare their answers before conducting feedback. You could invite one learner to the front of the room to take on the role of teacher and elicit answers, writing them on the board:

1. *false*
2. *true etc.*

You could ask the learners some questions after this feedback stage, such as *Why does Sunita ask the man for some ID? Is this a good idea when people come to your home? Why?* etc

Task 2: grammar: infinitives with 'to'

Tell the learners that the film contains lots of language that they can use or that they might hear if someone like a meter reader, comes to their home, and that Task 2 shows them some of this useful language. Ask the learners to complete Task 2, ensuring that they understand that only 3 of the 6 sentences need 'to'.

Before conducting feedback, put the learners in groups and get them to try to agree which 3 sentences need 'to' and which don't. After feedback, ask the learners *What is the grammar rule about 'to'?* Elicit the rule that *need* and *would like* require *to*; *can* does not.

Task 3: practice

Explain that the learners are going to practise using the rule you just elicited. Give the learners a few minutes to complete Task 3 and check their answers with their partner and the whole group. Then tell learners to ask and answer the questions in small groups.

Task 4: more useful phrases - speaking with people who come to your home

There are two stages to Task 4; set up the task carefully to be sure that the learners know what to do. In (a), they need to select the correct word to make the phrase from the film. Allow them two minutes to do this, and then elicit feedback. You might need to check understanding of *ID*, *my pleasure*, and *I've got your reading*.

In (b), they need to identify who said the phrases in the film. They should be able to work out the answers, but you may want to play the film again to help the learners with Task 3, especially with weaker groups.

Then practise the phrases, by asking learners questions such as:

Which phrase can you use ...

... to say 'thank you when someone does something for you? (Thank you for your help.)

... after someone says 'thank you'? (My pleasure)

... when you want a visitor to come into your flat? (Come in)

Extension

If you feel your learners would enjoy this, distribute the transcript (pages 13 and 14) and tell learners to act out the roles of Sunita and the meter reader (missing out the final short scene with Arjun, Sunita's husband).

Task 5: a survey

Task 5 follows on from the theme of meter readings and accurate billing and consists of a survey for the learners to complete in or out of class.

Note – You will need to decide how exactly you wish to use the survey, whether to have the learners survey each other in class, or to have them ask the questions to other people from outside the class, e.g. other ESOL learners in your institution. You can also decide whether to give each learner just one question to ask to everyone else, or to let each person ask each question. All this depends on the logistics of time, number of learners, level etc, and you as the teacher will be in the best position to decide how to make this activity work with your group. You will also need to decide what the final outcome of the survey is going to be, for example a presentation to the class, a piece of writing (done in groups or individually) etc.

In pairs, get the learners to put the words into the correct order to make questions. Check that the questions are formed correctly. Drill the pronunciation. It would be worth teaching the phrases: *I pay by direct debit*, *by cheque*, etc, and any other phrases you think your learners may want to use in order to answer the questions.

Someone at the door – Electricity meter reading – Teacher's pack

If you expect the learners to be asking large numbers of people the questions, you could suggest that they record answers in the right section of the box as follows:

1. I
2. II
3. III
4. IIII
5. IIII
6. IIII I
7. IIII II etc.

As the learners ask and answer questions, monitor and make a note of any spoken errors that you feel should be dealt with during feedback. Then write the errors on the board (anonymously) and encourage learners in groups to try to correct them. Elicit feedback, making sure the learners understand the reasons for the error, and get the whole class and individuals to say the sentence correctly.

Extension

Having done the survey, you could set a further task using the survey results. Either:

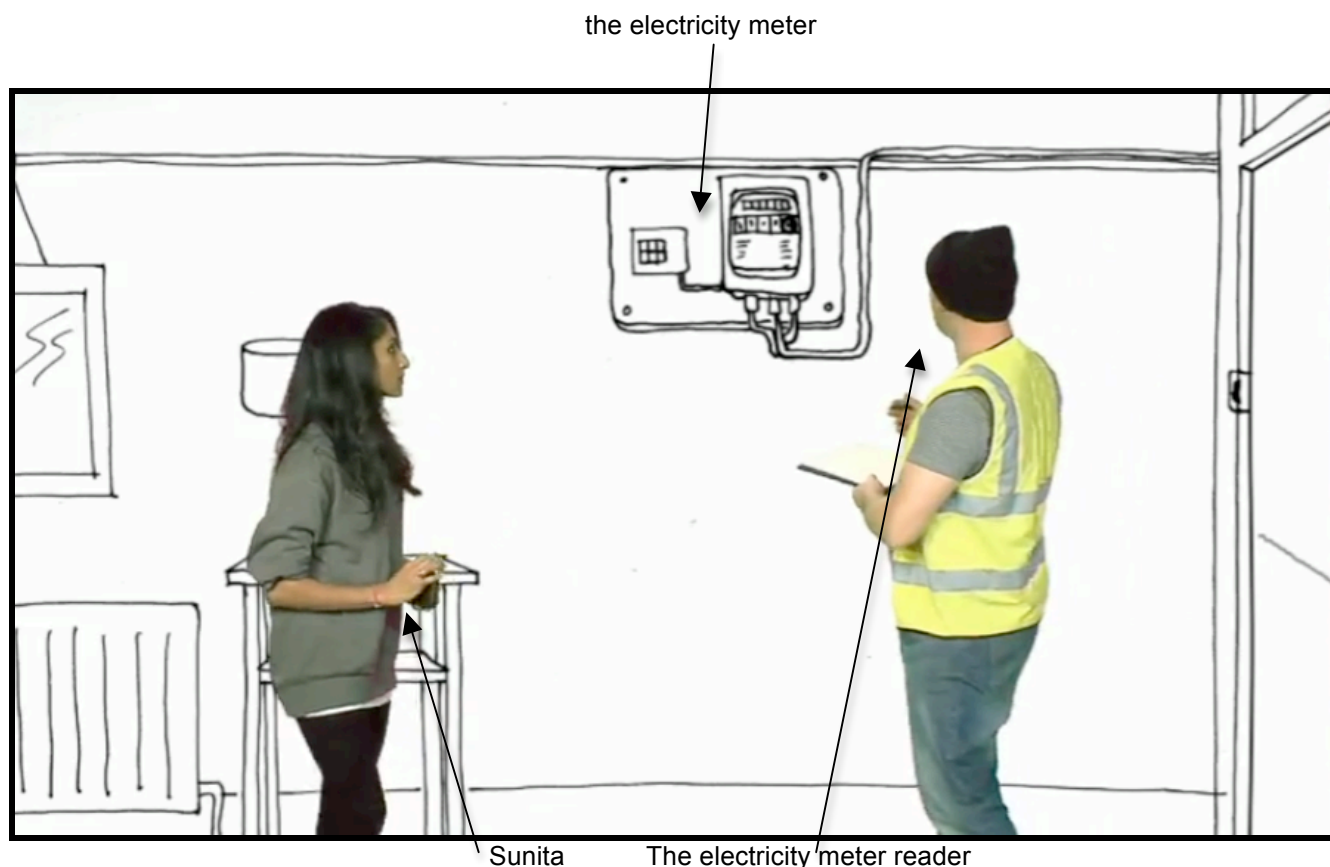
- ask the learners to work in small groups and prepare a Powerpoint presentation about all or some of the findings, and put the statistical results into pie charts. To make an online pie chart, you could use: <http://nces.ed.gov/nceskids/createagraph/>
- ask the learners to produce a written report summarising the survey results.

You may need to provide a model presentation or report yourself if you choose one of these tasks.

Alternatively, you could set learners the task of designing and completing a survey on a completely different topic, such as food / shopping habits / favourite TV programmes etc.

Refer learners to the online versions of these ESOL Nexus activities about *Electricity meter reading*:
<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/english-my-home/someone-door-electricity-meter-reading>

Electricity meter reading – learner resources



Task 1: understanding the film

Watch the film. Are the statements true or false?

1. The man comes to Sunita's flat to get the money for her electricity.
2. The man shows Sunita where her electricity meter is.
3. The man wants to see how much electricity Sunita has used.
4. Sunita can pay her electricity bills on the internet.
5. Sunita asks the man to show some identification.
6. The man also wants to read her gas meter and water meter.
7. In future, Sunita can read the meters herself.
8. Arjun (Sunita's husband) helps Sunita read the gas meter.

Someone at the door – Electricity meter reading – Teacher's pack

Task 2: grammar: infinitives with *to*

Add 'to' in the correct place in **three** of the sentences.

1. I'd like look at your electricity meter please, if that's alright.
2. I need take the reading of your electricity for the bill.
3. I need read the meter and write down the numbers.
4. Or you can use the internet.
5. You can read the meters yourself.
6. And then you can phone and tell us.

Task 3: practice

Choose the correct word or phrase. Then ask and answer the questions.

1. What bills do you need / need to pay this week?
2. What things can / need you pay for on the internet?
3. How often do you need to paying / to pay your electricity bills?
4. What would you like to / need to do at the weekend?

Task 4: Useful phrases - speaking with people who come your home

a Choose the correct word to make the phrases from the film.



Sunita



The meter reader

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1. I'm sorry, I <u>don't</u> / <u>'m not</u> understand. S | 5. I've got your <u>read</u> / <u>reading</u> now. |
| 2. Let me explain <u>that</u> / <u>how</u> it works. MR | 6. Thank you <u>for</u> / <u>with</u> your help. |
| 3. Could I see <u>some</u> / <u>an</u> ID please? | 7. My <u>please</u> / <u>pleasure</u> . |
| 4. <u>Go</u> / <u>Come</u> in. | 8. You <u>have</u> / <u>make</u> a good day now. |

b Look at sentences 1-8 from the conversation.

Who says them? Write 'S' for Sunita, or 'MR' for meter reader.

Task 5: A survey

Put the words in the correct order to make questions.

Then ask other people the questions.

Question 1

read – your – Do – you – electricity – sometimes – meter ?

.....

Yes	No	Not sure

Question 2

the – electricity – Where – is – meter – home – in – your?

.....

Hall	Kitchen	Toilet	Other	Not sure

Question 3

Do – meter – visit – your – home – readers – ever ?

.....

Yes	No	Not sure

Question 4

How – pay – your – bills – do – you – electricity?

.....

Cheque	Internet payment	Direct debit	Other / not sure

Transcript

- Meter reader:** Hello, I'm from City Electricity Services. I'd like to look at your electricity meter please, if that's alright.
- Wife:** I'm sorry, I don't understand.
- Meter reader:** I need to take the reading of your electricity for the bill.
- Wife:** Oh, I see, the electricity bill. Yes, sorry, how much is it?
- Meter reader:** No no no, you don't understand. I'm not here to take the money.
- Wife:** Oh, I see, there isn't a bill?
- Meter reader:** No, not yet... You're not from this country are you?
- Wife:** No, we've just moved here from India... just last month.
- Meter reader:** Welcome to London then! Let me explain how it works. In your home, you've got a meter-
- Wife:** One metre?
- Meter reader:** No, it's like a little machine with numbers. I think that's it, just there.
- Wife:** Oh, I see.
- Meter reader:** The numbers show how much electricity you've used. I need to take the reading... I need to read the meter and write down the numbers. And then we'll send you a bill in the post.
- Wife:** Oh right.
- Meter reader:** But no-one will come to collect the money. If someone calls saying they're collecting money, they're probably not genuine.
- Wife:** Not.. genuine?
- Meter reader:** Not real... not who they say they are. You pay, through your bank. Or you can use the internet.
- Wife:** Oh right. I see. Could I see some ID please?
- Meter reader:** Yes, of course. *(The meter reader shows her a photo-ID card.)* This is me when I was younger and better-looking!
- Wife:** Come in.
- Meter reader:** Thank you.

Someone at the door – Electricity meter reading – Teacher's pack

(The meter reader goes in, looks at the electricity meter, and writes down the numbers)

Meter reader: Right, thanks, I've got your reading now. So you'll get your next bill in the post soon.

Wife: Thanks.

Meter reader: And you know you've got your gas meter out there? And also your water meter.

Wife: Yes, I know. Well, I didn't know. But I know now! Thank you for your help.

Meter reader: My pleasure. And if you want, you can read the meters yourself.

Wife: Really?

Meter reader: Yeah. Simple. You just write down the numbers on the meter. And then you can phone and tell us. Or you can do it on the internet. Same with your gas and water.

Wife: Oh, well it's useful to know that. Thank you.

Meter reader: At least you know the bill's always right. Anyway, that's it! You have a good day now!

Wife: Thank you very much. Bye.

Wife: Bye bye.

(later that day)

Wife: Gas 37591

Husband: What are you doing?

Wife: Reading the gas meter.

Husband: What?

Wife: So that we get the right bill.

Husband: Why?

Wife: Don't you know anything!?

Unit 1a Someone at the door: Electricity meter reading – answers**Task 1: understanding the film**

1. false
2. true
3. true
4. true
5. true
6. false
7. true
8. false

Task 2: grammar: infinitives with to

1. I'd like TO look at your electricity meter please, if that's alright.
2. I need TO take the reading of your electricity for the bill.
3. I need TO read the meter and write down the numbers.
4. OK – to not needed
5. OK – to not needed
6. OK – to not needed

Task 3: practice

1. need to
2. can
3. to pay
4. like to

Task 4: useful phrases for speaking with visitors to your home

1. don't (Sunita)
2. how (Meter reader)
3. some (Sunita)
4. Come (Sunita)
5. reading (Meter reader)
6. for (Sunita)
7. pleasure (Meter reader)
8. have (Meter reader)

Task 5: A survey

1. Do you sometimes read your electricity meter?
2. Where is the electricity meter in your home?
3. Do meter readers ever visit your home?
4. How do you pay your electricity bills?

'Someone at the door – 1a – Meter reading' video

The video that accompanies the activities for Unit 1 'Someone at the door – Electricity meter reading' is available to watch on the ESOLNexus website.

